

Some muscles are named after their shapes (e.g. the rhomboideus major), whereas others are named according to their bone attachments (e.g. the intercostals between the ribs, or costae) or the movement they produce. Flexor muscles act to bend a limb at the joint they span, while their opposing equivalents, the extensors, straighten the joint. Abductor muscles cause movement away from the midline of the body, as when holding the arm out to the side. Their adductor partners are responsible for the reverse movement back towards the midline. In this illustration the superficial muscles are on the right side, with deeper ones to the left.

